



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	23 November 2022	Time of Incident:	11:00am
Region / Directorate:	IDD	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number:	29117
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Tele-Handler Overloaded
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Executive Summary:

On 23 November 2022 at approximately 9:30am the formwork for a 1 x 1 x 0.94m concrete gantry pillar was inspected by the Supervisor. The Supervisor was not comfortable with the formwork construction (due to concrete delivery time constraints the Supervisor was assisting the formwork crew with formwork construction).

Concrete had been ordered for several work fronts commencing with the above gantry pillar and moving onto blinding for a nearby staircase. A Main Roads pre-pour inspection was carried out at 9:50am and minor issues with reinforcement were identified and rectified.

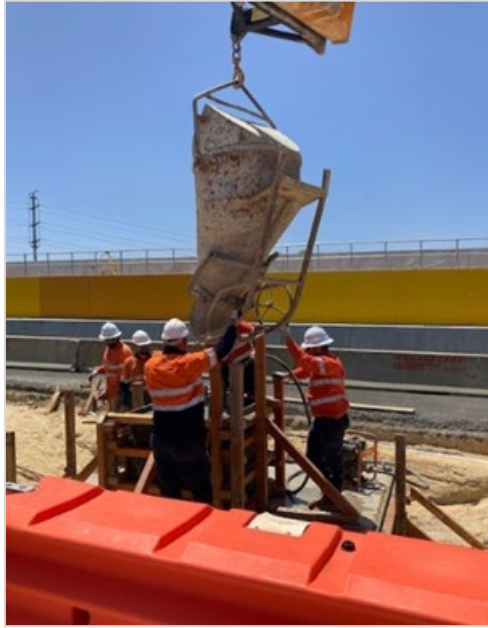
Concrete arrived at 10:00am and was placed on hold whilst a mobile water pump/trailer was used to wash out the formwork and construction joint at the base of the pillar. The tele-handler picked up the concrete kibble and moved into position where the concrete agitator (agi) truck was to reverse onto. Access into, out of, and around the gantry base was tight and required multiple workers to act as spotters for reversing vehicles.

Concrete was tested at 10:35am and loading of the kibble commenced. The first kibble load was poured without issue then the tele-handler drove back to the agi truck to refill. The second kibble load was driven back to the discharge alignment and poured with the amber warning lights showing up in the Operator's cab. The tele-handler drove back to the agi truck for the 3rd kibble load, was filled and returned to the same discharge alignment as per the previous two kibble loads.

At 10:55am whilst extending the tele-handler boom, the load alarm orange & red lights commenced flashing and the audible beeper sounded. The Operator then overrode the alarm function, continued to extend the machine boom until he noticed the rear of the machine rising as the machine started to rock forward. The Operator promptly retracted the boom, concrete loading was adjusted, and the pour was completed.

At 11:05am the Supervisor ceased the other concrete pours, sent the remaining concrete away, and reported the near miss incident.

Incident Photos:



500L kibble suspended from tele-handler. Workers in close proximity of kibble.



Wheels approximately 300mm off the ground.



Gross weight (full capacity) = 1080 kg approximately



Boom angle = 20 degrees



Load (1080kg) ÷ Capacity (850kg) x 100 = Utilisation 127%



Boom extension = 3.7m

Contributing Factors:

- The immediate cause of the near miss was the tele-handler was operated beyond the design lifting capacity when warning alarms were ignored, and the override function was used to extend the boom.
 - Note: The override function is provided to allow the operator to override a hydraulic lock out function and retract the boom.
- Additional contributing factors include:
 - Operator relied on the machine's load warning system for operation.
 - Fundamental lift study planning was not carried out - i.e. the load chart was not used to calculate utilisation percentage.
 - Workers may have been experiencing time pressures imposed by the project.

Corrective Actions:

- Develop and implement a 'Lift Card'. The lift card is a front-line planning tool for the calculation and recording of plant utilisation percentage using the applicable mobile plant lift chart.
- Identify personnel holding required competency certificates and licences for operation of mobile plant as a crane. Ensure only authorised personnel operate mobile plant.
- Disciplinary action to be taken for breach of duty of care.
- Develop a Safety Alert to share the learning opportunities across the business.
- Coaching of key personnel in relation to effective planning of works.



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Lifting Operations.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations